Auto Updates Status for MainWP: Installation Guide

By ProAdmin · Version 1.1.0 · October 2026

Installing takes about two minutes: upload one zip on your MainWP Dashboard site, activate it, and the Auto Updates widget appears on the Operations page.

Before you start

Requirement	Details
MainWP Dashboard	Installed and active. Tested with version 6.3.
WordPress	6.2 or newer
PHP	7.4 or newer
Your account	A WordPress administrator who can install plugins
The plugin file	`auto-updates-status-for-mainwp.zip` (version 1.1.0), saved to your computer

Install it on the Dashboard site (for example proadmin.com), not on your child sites.

Install the plugin

1. Log in to your MainWP Dashboard site's WordPress admin (`/wp-admin`).
2. Go to **Plugins → Add New Plugin** and click **Upload Plugin** at the top.
3. Click **Choose File**, select `auto-updates-status-for-mainwp.zip`, then click **Install Now**. Don't unzip it first.
4. When the upload finishes, click **Activate Plugin**.
5. Check that **Auto Updates Status for MainWP** shows as active on the Plugins page. It's also listed in MainWP under **Add-ons → Manage Add-ons**.

When you activate it, the plugin creates two database tables for history (`wp_mainwp_aus_runs` and `wp_mainwp_aus_items`, using your site's table prefix). It also imports whatever MainWP already holds about recent runs. It doesn't change any MainWP settings.

Show the widget

1. Open **MainWP → Operations** (`admin.php?page=mainwp_tab`).
2. Find the **Auto Updates** widget. New widgets are added after the existing ones, so you may need to scroll down.

3. If it's missing, click the **cog icon (Page Settings)** in the top bar, turn on **Auto Updates Status**, and save.
4. Drag the widget by its title to wherever you want it. To keep that arrangement, save it with the **Layout** button.

Use the ⋮ menu on the widget to switch between **Status**, **Latest Run**, **Run History** and **Recent Failures**. The widget remembers your last choice in your browser. The ↻ icon refreshes the widget without reloading the page.

Check that it's working

The **Status** view should fill in right away. Details for each update only appear after MainWP's next scheduled run.

- ☐ The **Status** card shows Scheduled, Running, Overdue or Disabled, and it matches your MainWP settings.
- ☐ **Next Run** shows the date and time set under **MainWP → Settings** (frequency and time for automatic updates).
- ☐ **Update types** shows green labels for the types set to "Install Trusted Updates" (core, plugins, themes, translations).
- ☐ After the next scheduled run, **Latest Run** lists each update with its site, version change and result.
- ☐ **Add-ons → Auto Updates Status for MainWP** opens the full history page.

The widget only shows history from the day you activate it. MainWP doesn't keep results from older runs, so earlier runs appear with their start time only and are marked "No details". While a run is in progress, the widget shows a progress bar and refreshes itself every 60 seconds.

Settings, updates and removal

History retention. On the extension page (**Add-ons → Auto Updates Status for MainWP**), set **Keep history for (days)**. The default is 90, and 0 keeps everything. Runs older than this are removed after each run finishes. Only administrators can change this setting.

Installing a newer version. Upload the new zip the same way. When WordPress asks, choose **Replace current with uploaded**. Your history and settings are kept.

Upgrading from version 1.0.x. Version 1.1.0 renamed the plugin from "MainWP Auto Updates Status Extension" to "Auto Updates Status for MainWP", and its folder from `mainwp-auto-updates-status` to `auto-updates-status-for-mainwp`. Because the folder changed, WordPress treats it as a new plugin. To keep your history:

1. Deactivate **MainWP Auto Updates Status Extension** on the Plugins page.
2. Remove its folder, `wp-content/plugins/mainwp-auto-updates-status`, by FTP or your host's file manager. Don't click **Delete** on the Plugins page, because that permanently erases the history.

3. Install and activate `auto-updates-status-for-mainwp.zip` as described above. It picks up your existing history and settings.

Removing it.

- **Deactivate** hides the widget and stops recording. Your history stays in the database, and recording picks up again when you reactivate. Runs that happen while it's deactivated aren't recorded.
- **Delete** (after deactivating) permanently removes the two history tables and the extension's settings. MainWP itself isn't affected.

Troubleshooting

What you see	What to do
A red notice saying MainWP Dashboard is required	Activate the MainWP Dashboard plugin first. The extension only runs alongside it.
No widget on Operations	Turn on **Auto Updates Status** in Page Settings (cog icon). Check that you're on the main Operations page, because the widget doesn't appear on individual site pages.
Status says **Disabled**	Core, plugin and theme auto updates are all off. Set at least one to "Install Trusted Updates" in MainWP settings.
Status says **Overdue**	The scheduled time passed over an hour ago without a run. Check that WP-Cron or your server cron is triggering on the Dashboard site.
Latest Run is empty	No run has finished since you activated the plugin. Wait for the next scheduled run.
A run shows **Nothing to update**	It ran, but no trusted plugins or themes had updates past the delay period. Check your trusted items and **Update delay**.
A team member can't see the widget	By default only WordPress administrators with MainWP access to the global dashboard can see it. A developer can allow other roles with the `mainwp_aus_capability` filter.
An update shows **Failed** or **Rolled back**	Hover the label to see the error from the child site, then check that site directly.

Known limitations

- **Batch updates during an automatic run.** Live progress and each run's site count use the same per-site start time that MainWP's batch updates use. If you start a batch update while an automatic run is in progress, the progress bar drops and that run's site count is too low. A batch update also holds MainWP's scheduled tasks, so the Status card can show **Overdue** until it finishes.
- **Multisite.** On a WordPress multisite network, activating and deleting the plugin only affects the current site. Install it on the single site that runs MainWP Dashboard, and don't network-activate it.

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